# Perfecting the Prayer Life

*Believers are to devote themselves to watchful, thankful prayer — including prayer for open doors and clear words for the gospel — and then to walk wisely toward outsiders, buy up every opportunity, and speak with grace seasoned with salt.*

# Where this study fits

*Colossians · twelve studies · this study highlighted*

**01 1:1–8**
**Faith, Love, and Hope in Colossae**

**02 1:9–14**
**Paul’s Prayer for the Colossians**

**03 1:15–23**
**The Savior of the Gospel**

**04 1:24–29**
**Christ in You, the Hope of Glory**

**05 2:1–7**
**The Believer’s Education**

**06 2:8–15**
**Beware of Philosophy**

**07 2:16–23**
**Run the Race Set Before You**

**08 3:1–11**
**Looking Up, Putting Off**

**09 3:12–17**
**Service Manual for the Lord’s Army**

**10 3:18–4:1**
**The Relationships of the New Man**

**11 4:2–6**
**Perfecting the Prayer Life**

**12 4:7–18**
**Portrait of a Ministry Team**

# Paul’s plan for evangelism

*Colossians 4:2–6 · The commentary’s outline*

| I. Supplication | II. Presentation | III. Implementation | IV. Conversation |
|---|---|---|---|
| **προσκαρτερέω**<br>Devoted, alert, thankful prayer | **θύρα**<br>Pray for an open door and a clear message | **ἐξαγοράζω**<br>Walk wisely toward outsiders; buy up the opportunity | **ἅλας**<br>Speech with grace, seasoned with salt, fitted to each person |
| v.2 | vv.3–4 | v.5 | v.6 |

It begins on our knees, continues in our walk and is carried in our talk.

# Supplication: three marks of prayer

*Colossians 4:2 · Outline I.A–C*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Devoted** | Persist in it, be busily engaged in it — as the early church did (Acts 2:42). Not a luxury but a necessity, like breathing. | **προσκαρτερέω**<br>to hold fast to |
| **Alert — before** | Don’t rush in unprepared; don’t let the enemy spoil your spirit first | **γρηγορέω**<br>stay awake (Matt 26:40–41) |
| **Alert — during** | Guard against wandering thoughts — “every thought captive” (2 Cor 10:5) | **—**<br>a meeting with the Ruler |
| **Alert — after** | Look confidently for the answer: yes, no — or wait. Keep praying. | **—**<br>the Spirit helps (Rom 8:26) |
| **Thankful** | “With an attitude of thanksgiving” — Colossians is one of the most thankful books in the NT | **εὐχαριστία**<br>1:3, 12; 2:7; 3:15–17; 4:2 |

A believer who does not pray is demonstrating independence from God: “apart from Me you can do nothing” (John 15:5).

# Presentation: pray for an open door

*Colossians 4:3–4 · Outline II.A–D*

### A The chance · v.3a

**θύρα**
Not an open cell, but “a door for the word” — God is the expert in doors (Acts 16:6–7; Rev 3:7–8)

### B The communication · v.3b

“The mystery of Christ” — Gentiles fellow heirs in one body (1:26–27; Eph 3:4–6)

### C The complication · v.3c

**δέω Perf. Pass.**
Imprisoned for this very message — yet it advanced the gospel (Phil 1:12–13)

### D The charge · v.4

**φανερόω · δεῖ**
“Make it clear in the way I ought” — clarity, not cleverness; a necessity (1 Cor 9:16)

“Push” may be a good motto for business. For gospel doors, pray — then watch and walk through them eagerly.

# Our walk and our talk

*Colossians 4:5–6 · Outline III–IV — Implementation and conversation*

**The walk — v.5**
περιπατέω · ἐξαγοράζω · καιρός

Wisdom toward outsiders — what our daily walk looks like to them

Not beating people over the head with the truth

Buy up the opportunity — redeem it from the marketplace

Kairos: not clock time, but the right moment

**The talk — v.6**
ἅλας · ἀρτύω · ἀποκρίνομαι

Sweetness: speech always with grace

Seasoning: wholesome, attractive, not bland — occasionally a sharper word

Scripture: “how you should respond to each person”

Ready with gentleness and reverence (1 Pet 3:15)

Witness is personal: one answer does not fit everyone. Knowing how to answer requires knowing the Word (Matt 4:4, 7, 10).

# Discuss and apply

*Colossians 4:2–6 · from the study's posted questions and applications*

## Discuss

1. What does “keeping alert” in prayer involve, and how might it change your prayer life?

2. Paul was in chains, yet he asked for an open door rather than an open cell. What does that reveal about his priorities?

## Apply

**Pray for Open Doors, by Name**
Write their names on a card, pray daily for an open door with each, and watch for the opportunity.

**Be Ready to Answer**
Write a simple gospel explanation from John 3:16, 5:24 and 6:47, and practice sharing it with a believer.

**In one line:** Pray on your knees, walk wisely before outsiders, and talk with grace — God opens the doors.